

```
#sudo xprobe2 192.168.0.10
```

The tool works only if ICMP is not blocked, i.e., ping is not blocked on the system that is to be tested.

```
#sudo xprobe2 -B xyzxyz.com
```

Here, the B option forces the TCP handshake module that tries to guess which the open TCP port is.

You can also use *nmap* for getting the OS details of a remote system, as follows:

```
#sudo nmap -O <ip addr of Host>
```

Here, O enables OS detection.

If the OS doesn't get detected, then use the following option to guess the OS.

```
#sudo nmap -O --osscan-guess 192.168.61.2
```

Here, *osscan-guess* can guess the OS more aggressively.

—Rupin Puthukudi, rupinmp@gmail.com



Easy-to-read grep output

When we use *grep* to filter text (e.g., Web logs, source code or program output), the pattern we are looking for might be anywhere in the matched lines. Hence, output will be a little difficult to read when we look for exactly where the match occurred.

In this case, we can use the following command:

```
#grep --color=always PATTERN
```

... which will show the output with matching characters in red, by default. This output is easy to read.

We can customise the colours with *GREP_COLOR* and *GREP_COLORS* environment variables, as shown below:

```
export GREP_COLOR="01;31"
```

```
grep --color=always int SomeCProgram.c
```

This will show all *int* strings in *SomeCProgram.c* in blue.

With *GREP_COLORS*, we can customise even further, like have a different colour for file names and a different colour for line numbers.

For complete information beyond this small tip (what exactly the colour codes are, what else can be coloured, what other customisations are possible, etc), I would

suggest searching the Web for 'grep with colour'.

—Prem Ranjan, ranjan_september@yahoo.com



Finding and getting rid of big files

A common problem with computers is when you have a number of large files (such as audio/video clips) that you want to get rid of. You can find the biggest files in the current directory with the following command (*only* in the current directory).

```
#ls -lSr
```

The *r* causes the large files to be listed at the end, and the *h* gives human readable output (MB and such).

You can search for the biggest MP3/MPEG files, using the following command:

```
#ls -lSr *.mp3
```

You can also look for the largest directories with:

```
#du -kx | egrep -v "\././" | sort -n
```

You can find the biggest files in your home directory (in the whole directory structure), using the command given below:

```
#find ~ -type f -exec ls -s {} \; | sort -n
```

To list only the top 10 biggest files, use the following command:

```
#find ~ -type f -exec ls -s {} \; | sort -nr | head -10
```

Hope this simple tip will help you address this common problem.

—Pallavi Rawat, pallavifirst@rediffmail.com



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